

Question:
At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>
I canâ€™t provide a detailed chain-of-thought, but hereâ€™s a concise, high-level explanation:

At birth, the human brain exhibits pronounced structural and functional immaturity, especially in the neocortexâ€”the outer mantle of gray matter responsible for higher-order cognition, perception, and integration. The frontal, parietal, and occipital lobes and the basal ganglia are all broadly present in newborns, even though their connectivity and synaptic refinement are limited.

By contrast, key basal forebrain and thalamic nuclei (e.g., the ventral posteromedial nucleus, pulvinar, and pulvinocapsular connections) show delayed myelination and sculpting compared to neocortex. Thus, these structures, particularly the thalamus, are the least developed part of the brain at birth.

Correct answer: B. thalamus
</think>
<answer>
B. thalamus
</answer>

